



NEW DOMAIN—Andy Cohen begins to get acquainted with Victory Field as the new manager of the Indianapolis Indians visited the park yesterday. (Star photo by Herb Rhodes)

New Boss Of Indians Avoids Pennant Talk

By MAX GREENWALD

"Cohen batting for Fitzsimons."

"Moriarity leaving the park."

This is one of baseball's oldest after-dinner jokes. In fact, the inspiration for this bit of humor uses it himself, to lead off speaking engagements.

He is, of course, Andy Cohen, the new manager of the Indianapolis Indians, who made a pleasing appearance at Victory Field yesterday.

WELL TANNED after serving as manager in the Canal Zone winter league, Cohen was making his first Indianapolis showing, after being named as successor to Kerby Farrell as pilot of the community-owned Tribesmen.

A balding, cigar-smoking, 5-9 175-pounder, the chunky Cohen resembles Al Lopez, another of his predecessors to use Indianapolis as a stepping stone to the major leagues.

Cohen, who admits being 49 years old, is not a fellow who will be at a loss for words—either in discussions with umpires or before banquet gatherings.

That story about pinch-hitting for the Irishman, which started when Andy was with the New York Giants (hitting 294 in his best of three seasons as infielder) didn't exactly happen that way.

IT REALLY started, Andy admits, at Buffalo in 1927. And it was "Cohen batting for Malone." And there was a fan who decided that was the time to leave the park. But it was "Flanigan leaving the park."

Anyway, it's a good story which has held up over the years.

Cohen is cordial to questioners but, having been in the managerial business since 1939, he isn't predicting pennant-winners at the drop of a pencil.

"I'm not certain what ma-

terial Indianapolis will start the season with," Cohen pointed out. "Further, I haven't any idea as to the makeup of the other clubs."

ANDY IS EXPECTING considerable help from the Chicago White Sox and he will have to deal with the Windy City club's new manager, the aforementioned Lopez. This is the first year of Indianapolis' working agreement with the Sox after being associated with Cleveland since 1952.

A definite requirement is a shortstop and the Tribe also is seeking a right-handed swatting outfielder. Pitching appears to be the 1957 Indians' strong point.

Aside from being subjected to the usual barrage from newspaper and radio-television personnel, Cohen talked over the Tribe's prospects with Ownie Bush, Indians' president.

This was far from a meeting of strangers as seven of Andy's eight seasons at Minneapolis were under the managership of Bush.

Cohen was not too surprised at being called to the Indianapolis helm because of his friendship with Bush. Further, the White Sox have been wanting him for their organization.

ANDY PILOTED at New Orleans the past two years and prior to that spent four seasons with Denver when the Bears were in the Western League.

No. 1 helper to Cohen will be Johnny Hutchings, the jolly former pitcher who signed in officially to return as coach.

Also on hand to greet the new pilot were three members of the Indians, Inc., board of directors, Frank E. McKinney, Bob Kirby and Dave Lewis.

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